

Immigration Rules

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(/guidance/immigration-rules/updates)

Summary

A collection of the current Immigration Rules.

The Immigration Rules are some of the most important pieces of legislation that make up the UK's immigration law. They are updated on a regular basis and all changes can be found in the Immigration Rules: statement of changes (<https://www.gov.uk/government/collections/immigration-rules-statement-of-changes>).

The rules are divided into different documents. The index page will help you find the part you need.

You can view the archived copies (<https://www.gov.uk/government/collections/archive-immigration-rules>) of the consolidated Immigration Rules as they were on the date before each statement of changes came into effect.

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The rules are divided into different documents. The index page will help you find the part you need.

Immigration Rules: introduction

(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-introduction)

This contains an explanation of who's covered by the Immigration Rules, dates of effect and definitions/interpretations of the terms used.

Immigration Rules part 1: leave to enter or stay in the UK

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-part-1-leave-to-enter-or-stay-in-the-uk\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-part-1-leave-to-enter-or-stay-in-the-uk)

General provisions regarding entry clearance, leave to enter or remain in the United Kingdom (paragraphs 7 to 39E).

Immigration Rules part 2: transitional provisions

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-part-2-transitional-provisions\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-part-2-transitional-provisions)

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Immigration Rules part 4: work experience

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-part-4-work-experience\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-part-4-work-experience)

Persons seeking to enter or remain in the United Kingdom in an "au pair" placement, as a working holidaymaker or for training or work experience (paragraphs 122 to 127).

Immigration Rules part 5: working in the UK

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-part-5-working-in-the-uk\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-part-5-working-in-the-uk)

Persons seeking to enter or remain in the United Kingdom for employment (paragraphs 128A to 199B).

Immigration Rules part 6: self-employment and business people

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-part-6-self-employment-and-business-people\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-part-6-self-employment-and-business-people)

Persons seeking to enter or remain in the United Kingdom as a businessman, self-employed person, investor, writer or composer or artist (paragraphs 200A to 237).

Immigration Rules part 6A: the points-based system

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-part-6a-the-points-based-system\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-part-6a-the-points-based-system)

Points-based system (paragraphs 245AAA to 245ZZE).

Immigration Rules part 7: other categories

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-part-7-other-categories\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-part-7-other-categories)

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[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-part-8-family-members\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-part-8-family-members)

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[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-part-suitability\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-part-suitability)

Part Suitability

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[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-part-11a-temporary-protection\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-part-11a-temporary-protection)

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[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-a-attributes\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-a-attributes)

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[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-administrative-review\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-administrative-review)

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Immigration Rules Appendix HM Armed Forces

Immigration Rules Appendix International Armed Forces and International Civilian Employees

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-international-armed-forces-and-international-civilian-employees\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-international-armed-forces-and-international-civilian-employees)

This route is for members of International Armed Forces and for International Civilian Employees of either a North Atlantic Treaty Organisation (NATO) force or the Australian Department of Defence.

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[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-e-maintenance-funds-for-the-family-of-relevant-points-based-system-migrants\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-e-maintenance-funds-for-the-family-of-relevant-points-based-system-migrants)

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Appendix ECAA: Extension of Stay

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Appendix ECAA Settlement: ECAA nationals and settlement

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[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-fm-family-members\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-fm-family-members)

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[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-fm-se-family-members-specified-evidence\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-fm-se-family-members-specified-evidence)

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[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-o-approved-english-language-tests\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-o-approved-english-language-tests)

List of English language tests that have been approved by the Home Office for English language requirements for limited leave to enter or remain under the Immigration Rules.

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[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-sn-service-of-notices\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-sn-service-of-notices)

Service of notices

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Permitted Activities for Visitors

Immigration Rules Appendix Visitor: Visa national list

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-visitor-visa-national-list\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-visitor-visa-national-list)

List of nationalities requiring entry clearance prior to travel to the UK as a Visitor, or for any other purpose for less than six months

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Immigration Rules Appendix VIP Delegate Visa

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-vip-delegate-visa\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-vip-delegate-visa)

This route is for a person accompanying a Head of State or Government Minister on an official visit to the UK for a temporary period (less than 1 month).

Immigration Rules Appendix Electronic Travel Authorisation

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-electronic-travel-authorisation\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-electronic-travel-authorisation)

Appendix Electronic Travel Authorisation

Immigration Rules Appendix ETA National List

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List of nationalities requiring an Electronic Travel Authorisation (ETA) prior to travel to the UK pursuant to Appendix Electronic Travel Authorisation.

Immigration Rules Appendix S2 Healthcare Visitor

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Immigration Rules Appendix Graduate

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-graduate\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-graduate)

This route is for a Student in the UK who wants to work, or look for work, following the successful completion of an eligible course of study at UK bachelor's degree-level or above. The study must have been with a higher education provider with a track record of compliance.

Immigration Rules Appendix Skilled Worker

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-skilled-worker\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-skilled-worker)

The Skilled Worker route is for employers to recruit people to work in the UK, including in UK waters, in a specific job. A Skilled Worker must have a job offer in an eligible skilled occupation from a Home Office-approved sponsor.

Immigration Rules Appendix Skilled Occupations

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-skilled-occupations\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-skilled-occupations)

Eligible SOC 2020 occupation codes and going rates for Skilled Worker, Global Business Mobility and Scale-up routes

Immigration Rules Appendix Immigration Salary List

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-immigration-salary-list\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-immigration-salary-list)

Occupations where a reduced skills and salary threshold applies in the Skilled Worker route.

Immigration Rules Appendix Global Business Mobility routes

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-global-business-mobility-routes\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-global-business-mobility-routes)

The Global Business Mobility routes are for workers based outside the UK who are undertaking a temporary work assignment in the UK as a Senior or Specialist Worker, Graduate Trainee, UK Expansion Worker, Service Supplier or Secondment Worker.

Immigration Rules Appendix T2 Minister of Religion

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-t2-minister-of-religion\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-t2-minister-of-religion)

This route is for a person who has a key leading role within their faith-based organisation or a religious order in the UK.

Immigration Rules Appendix Representative of an Overseas Business

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-representative-of-an-overseas-business\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-representative-of-an-overseas-business)

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Immigration Rules for UK Ancestry

Immigration Rules Appendix Global Talent

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-global-talent\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-global-talent)

The Global Talent route is for people aged 18 or over in the field of science, engineering, humanities, social science, medicine, digital technology or arts and culture who can show they have exceptional talent or exceptional promise.

Immigration Rules Appendix Global Talent: Prestigious Prizes

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-global-talent-prestigious-prizes\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-global-talent-prestigious-prizes)

Global Talent: Prestigious Prizes

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High Potential Individual

Immigration Rules Appendix Scale-up

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Appendix Scale-up

Immigration Rules Appendix Start-up

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-start-up\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-start-up)

The Start-up route is for a person seeking to establish a business in the UK for the first time. From 13 April 2023 this route is only available to those who hold a valid Start-up endorsement issued before the 13 April 2023. From 13 July 2023 the Start-up route will be closed to all new applications.

Immigration Rules Appendix Innovator Founder

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-innovator-founder\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-innovator-founder)

Appendix Innovator Founder

Immigration Rules Appendix International Sportsperson

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-international-sportsperson\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-international-sportsperson)

The International Sportsperson route is for an elite sportsperson or qualified sports coach who is internationally established and can make a significant contribution to the development of their sport at its highest level in the UK.

Immigration Rules Appendix Sports Governing Bodies

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-sports-governing-bodies\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-sports-governing-bodies)

Home Office approved Sports Governing Bodies for International Sportsperson applications.

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Overseas Domestic Worker

Immigration Rules Appendix Domestic Workers in a Private Household

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Immigration Rules Appendix Domestic Workers in a Private Household

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Appendix Domestic Worker Statement

Immigration Rules Appendix Temporary Work - Seasonal Worker

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-temporary-work-seasonal-worker\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-temporary-work-seasonal-worker)

The Seasonal Worker route is for a person who wants to come to the UK to do seasonal horticulture work or poultry production work.

Immigration Rules Appendix Youth Mobility Scheme

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-youth-mobility-scheme\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-youth-mobility-scheme)

The Youth Mobility Scheme provides a cultural exchange programme that allows a person aged between 18 and 30 (or 18-35 for some nationalities), from participating countries and territories, to experience life in the UK for up to 2 years (or 3 years for some nationalities).

Immigration Rules Appendix Youth Mobility Scheme: eligible nationals

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-youth-mobility-scheme-eligible-nationals\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-youth-mobility-scheme-eligible-nationals)

Countries and territories participating in the Youth Mobility Scheme and annual allocation of places for 2026.

Immigration Rules Appendix Temporary Work – Creative Worker

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-temporary-work-creative-worker\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-temporary-work-creative-worker)

The Temporary Work - Creative Worker route is for a person who wants to work within the creative sector.

Immigration Rules Appendix Temporary Work – Religious Worker

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-temporary-work-religious-worker\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-temporary-work-religious-worker)

The Religious Worker route is for a person who wants to support the activities of religious institutions in the UK by conducting religious work such as working in a religious order or undertaking non-pastoral work for a religious organisation.

Immigration Rules Appendix Temporary Work - Charity Worker

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-temporary-work-charity-worker\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-temporary-work-charity-worker)

The Charity Worker route is for a person who wants to come to the UK to do voluntary work for no more than 12 months.

Immigration Rules Appendix Temporary Work - International Agreement

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-temporary-work-international-agreement\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-temporary-work-international-agreement)

The International Agreement route is for a person who wants to come to the UK to provide a service covered under international law, such as private servants in diplomatic households, or employees of overseas governments and international organisations.

Immigration Rules Appendix Temporary Work – Government Authorised Exchange

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-temporary-work-government-authorised-exchange\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-temporary-work-government-authorised-exchange)

The Temporary Work - Government Authorised Exchange route is for a person who wants to come to the UK on an approved scheme for a period of 12 or 24 months (depending on the scheme).

Immigration Rules Appendix Government Authorised Exchange schemes

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-government-authorised-exchange-schemes\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-government-authorised-exchange-schemes)

The Temporary Worker – Government Authorised Exchange route is for a person who wishes to come to the UK on one of the approved schemes listed below.

Immigration Rules Appendix Creative Worker Codes of Practice

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-t5-creative-workers-codes-of-practice\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-t5-creative-workers-codes-of-practice)

Where a person is applying under Appendix Temporary Work – Creative Worker, as a creative worker, operating in dance, theatre, film and television, or as a model in the fashion industry, their sponsor must follow the relevant code of practice specified below and comply with the other requirements.

Immigration Rules Appendix Hong Kong British National (Overseas)

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-hong-kong-british-national-overseas\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-hong-kong-british-national-overseas)

There are two Hong Kong British National (Overseas) routes – the BN(O) Status Holder route and the BN(O) Adult Child route.

Immigration Rules Appendix Ukraine Scheme

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-ukraine-scheme\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-ukraine-scheme)

Appendix Ukraine Scheme

Immigration Rules Appendix Afghan Relocation and Assistance Policy (ARAP)

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-afghan-relocation-and-assistance-policy-arap\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-afghan-relocation-and-assistance-policy-arap)

This route is for Afghan citizens and their dependent family members to relocate to, or settle in, the UK where the Ministry of Defence has decided they meet the requirements for relocation to the UK as an eligible Afghan citizen under the ARAP ("the ARAP eligibility decision").

Immigration Rules Appendix UK/European Applicant Transfer Scheme

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-uk-european-applicant-transfer-scheme\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-uk-european-applicant-transfer-scheme)

Immigration Rules Appendix UK/European Applicant Transfer Scheme

Immigration Rules Appendix Temporary Permission to Stay for Victims of Human Trafficking or Slavery

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-temporary-permission-to-stay-for-victims-of-human-trafficking-or-slavery\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-temporary-permission-to-stay-for-victims-of-human-trafficking-or-slavery)

This route is to provide for temporary permission to stay for victims of human trafficking or slavery and their children.

Immigration Rules Appendix Family Reunion (Sponsors with Protection)

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-family-reunion-sponsors-with-protection\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-family-reunion-sponsors-with-protection)

Appendix Family Reunion (Sponsors with Protection)

Immigration Rules Appendix Child Relative (Sponsors with Protection)

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-child-relative-sponsors-with-protection\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-child-relative-sponsors-with-protection)

Appendix Child Relative (Sponsors with Protection)

Immigration Rules Appendix Adult Dependent Relative

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-adult-dependent-relative\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-adult-dependent-relative)

The Adult Dependent Relative route is for a person aged 18 or over who is sponsored by a relative in the UK (who must be a British Citizen, settled in the UK, have protection status or be a specified EEA national who has permission under Appendix EU) and where the sponsor is able to maintain, accommodate and care for the applicant without reliance on public funds.

Immigration Rules Appendix Long Residence

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-long-residence\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-long-residence)

The Long Residence route is for a person who has lived in the UK lawfully and continuously for 10 years or more. The person can count time with permission on most routes towards the 10 year qualifying period.

Immigration Rules Appendix Victim of Domestic Abuse

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-victim-of-domestic-abuse\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-victim-of-domestic-abuse)

Immigration Rules Appendix Victim of Domestic Abuse

Immigration Rules Appendix Bereaved Partner

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-bereaved-partner\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-bereaved-partner)

Appendix Bereaved Partner

Immigration Rules Appendix Adoption

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-adoption\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-adoption)

The adoption routes are for a child under the age of 18 to apply to come to the UK either to be adopted or having been adopted overseas.

Immigration Rules Appendix Private Life

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-private-life\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-private-life)

The Private Life route is for a person seeking permission to stay in the UK on the basis they have developed a Private Life in the UK.

Immigration Rules Appendix Settlement Family Life

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-settlement-family-life\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-settlement-family-life)

This route is for a person who has permission to stay as a partner or parent (or has had a combination of the two) under Appendix FM, and who is eligible to settle in the UK after a qualifying period of 10 years.

Immigration Rules Appendix Gurkha and Hong Kong military unit veteran discharged before 1 July 1997

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-gurkha-and-hong-kong-military-unit-veteran-discharged-before-1-july-1997\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-gurkha-and-hong-kong-military-unit-veteran-discharged-before-1-july-1997)

This route is for Gurkhas or Hong Kong military unit veterans who were discharged before 1 July 1997 to settle in the UK.

Immigration Rules Appendix ATAS: Academic Technology Approval Scheme (ATAS)

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-atas-academic-technology-approval-scheme-atas\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-atas-academic-technology-approval-scheme-atas)

ATAS seeks to prevent the transfer of information, knowledge or technology which could develop, advance or support an Advanced Conventional Military Technology (ACMT) and Weapons of Mass Destruction (WMD) programme or their means of delivery.

Immigration Rules Appendix English Language

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-english-language\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-english-language)

This Appendix sets out how the English language requirement is met.

Immigration Rules Appendix KOL UK

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-kol-uk\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-kol-uk)

This Appendix sets out how the Knowledge of Life in the UK requirement is met by a person applying for settlement.

Immigration Rules Appendix Finance

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-finance\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-finance)

This Appendix sets out how the financial requirement must be met.

Immigration Rules Appendix Returning Resident

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-returning-resident\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-returning-resident)

This route is for a 'Returning Resident', which means a person who previously had indefinite permission to enter or stay (settlement) in the UK which has now lapsed and who now wants to return to and settle in the UK.

Immigration Rules Appendix Statelessness

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-statelessness\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-statelessness)

This route is for a person in the UK who has no nationality and so is stateless, and is unable to become, or obtain a status leading to becoming, a permanent resident of another country.

Immigration Rules Appendix Continuous Residence

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-continuous-residence\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-continuous-residence)

This Appendix sets out how the continuous residence requirement is met.

Immigration Rules Appendix Relationship with Partner

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-relationship-with-partner\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-relationship-with-partner)

Relationship with Partner

Immigration Rules Appendix Children

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-children\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-children)

This Appendix sets out the requirements for applications made by children.

Immigration Rules Appendix Tuberculosis (TB)

[\(/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-tuberculosis-tb\)](/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-tuberculosis-tb)

This appendix sets out when a person is required to provide a valid TB certificate with their application for entry clearance and the requirements for a TB certificate to be valid.



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